

5.0 | DANGERS OF DRIVING

You know there are serious risks and consequences to driving. You will make mistakes, and those around you will make mistakes. Even though risk is always present, driving safely can reduce crash potential.

Navigating risk involves being aware, predictable, smooth, and proficient behind the wheel. To drive well and without incidents, you need to intentionally develop and use safe driving habits as your default driving style.

Fatal crash common factors

- Speed
- Impairment
- Distractions
- Unrestrained occupants
- Inexperience*

*In Washington, vehicle crashes are a leading causes of death for people ages 16 to 25. This age group is more susceptible to fatal and serious injury crashes.

RISK AWARENESS

Risk awareness is your ability to identify present and potential hazards on the road. It helps you be aware of things that might require you to change your behavior to avoid a crash. Risk awareness includes being mindful of other road users, weather conditions, and potential distractions.

Risk awareness relies on understanding what is happening around you and what may happen next.

- Keep your head scanning continually. Stay aware of what's happening in front of you, beside you, and behind you. You can do this by using your peripheral vision and mirrors.

